

Grade 7 English - Reading Response - The Lighthouse Keeper

Time: 20 minutes. Read the passage, then answer all three questions in full sentences.

The Lighthouse Keeper

Tomas kept the lighthouse on the rocky point at Grey Harbour. Every evening, as the sun slipped into the sea, he climbed the one hundred and twelve steps, wiped the great glass lens and lit the lamp. The big ships that once passed the point had stopped coming years ago, because a new road and a new port had been built far down the coast. Still, each night Tomas kept the lamp burning until dawn.

One stormy night a small fishing boat appeared out of the dark, tossed by the waves. The fisherman saw the steady light, turned his boat toward it, and found the safe channel into the harbour. In the morning he walked up to the lighthouse and shook Tomas's hand without a word. From that day on, Tomas no longer wondered whether the lamp was worth lighting. He climbed the steps each evening a little taller than before.

Q1. Who is the main character, and what does he do every evening?

Q2. Why does Tomas keep the lamp burning even though the big ships no longer come? Use evidence from the passage.

Q3. Write two or three sentences about how Tomas changes by the end of the passage.